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Probabilistic Reasoning in Intelligent Systems: Networks of Plausible Inference

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Research Summary (verbatim)

Exact inference in belief networks is computationally intractable in general directed acyclic graphs, but is linear in tree-structured models and polytrees. When latent variables mediate relationships among observed variables, tree structures allow information to propagate via local message passing between parent and child nodes. The recovery of underlying causal tree topologies from empirical boundary correlations constitutes a fundamental challenge in probabilistic and structural inference.

Pearl (1988), Morgan Kaufmann

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